Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) Template · Expert version

A work breakdown structure template helps you decompose a project into deliverables and work packages, each with a WBS code, owner, effort and cost, so nothing is missed and estimates roll up correctly.

How to use this template

1. Write the project's final deliverable as level 1.
2. Break it into major deliverables or phases at level 2, then into work packages at level 3.
3. Give each element a unique WBS code, a short description and a single owner.
4. Estimate effort and cost for each work package; the top row totals them.
5. Check the 100% rule: the children of each element add up to all of its work, and nothing more.
6. Use the work packages to build your schedule and budget.

Tips

- Name elements with nouns (deliverables), not verbs.
- Stop decomposing when a work package can be estimated and assigned.
- Keep a WBS dictionary for detail.
- Do not include work that is out of scope.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	Business analyst	1
Owner	Design lead	1
Owner	Ops lead	1
Owner	Project manager	2
Owner	QA lead	1
Owner	Tech lead	1
Owner	Trainer	1
Status	Not started	4
Status	In progress	3
Status	On hold	0
Status	Blocked	0
Status	Done	1

WBS · Decompose deliverables into work packages; totals roll up automatically

WBS code	Level	Deliverable / work package	Description	Owner	Effort (days)	Cost ($)	Status
1	1	Customer portal	The complete project	Project manager	96	76,800	In progress
1.1	2	Project management	Planning, reporting, governance	Project manager	10	8,000	In progress
1.2	2	Requirements	Workshops and signed-off requirements	Business analyst	8	6,400	Done
1.3	2	Design	UX and technical design	Design lead	12	9,600	In progress
1.4	2	Build	Front end, back end and integrations	Tech lead	40	32,000	Not started
1.5	2	Testing	System and user acceptance testing	QA lead	15	12,000	Not started
1.6	2	Training	Guides and sessions for support staff	Trainer	5	4,000	Not started
1.7	2	Deployment	Release and hypercare	Ops lead	6	4,800	Not started